

A failed method search becomes a rigorous negative-results paper

The multimodal-hallucination project repeatedly changes route without losing the objective, prior failures, official results, or manuscript state.

163.6 h campaign-hours	174 Engineer rounds	94 Reviewer revisions
29 session rolls	7 early rollbacks	2 late rollbacks



(b) Role-resolved scientific episodes

the same persistent campaign state crosses every episode

HYPOTHESIS PRUNING R M P

7 no-go gates prune weak routes

Official pilots expose missing signal or base-identical behavior. Reviewer rejects; Manager rolls back; Planner retires the branch.

strong-baseline coverage

conservative veto

bidirectional arbitration

contrastive decomposition

evidence-conflict taxonomy

forced-choice conflict slots

visual-delta decoding

SCIENTIFIC PIVOT P M

Change the claim, retain the evidence

positive method

negative-results audit

Failed routes become study objects.

CANONICAL EXPERIMENT E R

15 cells · 4,500 rows

POPE

AMBER

HallusionBench

5 methods

official scorers

paired audits

Engineer completes the matrix; Reviewer binds claims to official outputs.

PAPER CONSTRUCTION E R M

Analysis → draft → review

Measured no-op and degradation modes become a scoped paper with synchronized claims, citations, figures, and layout.

10 pages

AAAI-formatted manuscript

SUBMISSION RECOVERY R M E

2 late rollbacks repair the package

- official-scorer provenance and canonical run selection
- GPU saturation telemetry for HallusionBench replacements

The same 15-cell evidence is rebound and re-reviewed.

Durable state: failed hypotheses + canonical runs + reviewer decisions + manuscript artifacts survive 29 session replacements and remain available to the next mission.